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Method and arrangement for constructing and interconnecting prefabricated building modules

Abstract

A modular building system allows for quickly and easily erecting prefabricated wall panels on a building foundation at a construction site. The system allows for manufacturing and installing, at a high level, complete budding components, using steps that are highly repeatable and scalable, resulting in construction that is quick and efficient, and easily performed at many types and locations of construction sites. A system in accordance with the invention comprises a wall panel, a floor panel and a roof panel. The wall panel comprises a horizontal member supported along a bottom horizontal edge, and a plurality of vertical studs integral to the horizontal member and extending vertically downward from the horizontal member. A floor panel comprises a rail disposed rigidly fixed to the foundation and defining an enclosure to receive the plurality of vertical studs of the wall panel to thereby vertically position the wall panel upon the foundation.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This application is a divisional of the co-pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17,678,635, filed Feb. 23, 2022, and titled “METHOD AND ARRANGEMENT FOR CONSTRUCTING AND INTERCONNECTING PREFABRICATED BUILDING MODULES,” which claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 (e) of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/152,793, filed Feb. 23, 2021, and titled “Building Blocks in Construction Technology,” both of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The embodiments discussed in the present disclosure are generally related to construction technology. In particular, the embodiments discussed are related to construction and interconnection of prefabricated building modules for use in construction technology.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Existing construction technologies involve one-off (e.g., customized) build-on site approaches in which construction material is brought to the construction site. This has been the traditional methodology and approach for many years but has certain inherent challenges. Such challenges include non-availability of skilled workforce (e.g., manual labor), heavy and expensive on-site machinery, incorrect estimate of completion time of construction projects, delays in delivery of projects, weather, quality, wastage of materials, noise and air pollution, and cost involved in disposal of debris. This approach is also “one-off” and provides no repeatability or scalability leverage. Each building or project

is done differently, and results vary widely.

(3) Further, execution of construction projects needs an ensemble of technologies/domains such as, structural integration, civil engineering, mechanical joints, material science, etc. Although, there have been significant advancements in construction technologies, due to the above factors, the average cost of construction and the effective cost of owning a house is still high for a majority of aspiring owners.

(4) In order to address the aforesaid shortfalls of these build-on site approaches, usage of prefabricated building modules for construction is also commonplace and has been in practice for some time. For example, building modules could be prefabricated at factories under factory scaling, repeatability, and in-factory conditions, and then delivered to a building site for expeditious on-site assembly.

Prefabricated building modules are broadly classified into volumetric and non-volumetric types. A volumetric prefabricated building module is understood to persons skilled in the art as one which has a volume defined by a structured enclosure or boundary. A non-volumetric type is one wherein panels and other prefabricated components are stacked or packed together for storage and shipment with minimum space in-between. For some construction sites, for example, remote sites which are in primitive locations or otherwise too difficult to access, or where resources are difficult to acquire, or when weather conditions or environmental restrictions do not permit, construction using prefabricated modules are often the only practical option.

(5) The prefabricated components typically comprise a solid roof, floor, and wall panels that are joined together during on-site assembling. In typical configurations, wall panels, roof panels, and floors are interconnected, for example, by an upwardly opening U-shaped profile bracket attached to a flooring member.

(6) However, there remains a need in the art for constructing a modular housing system based on improved and robust prefabricated components to withstand load, climate changes, and daily wear and tear as may be subjected to any house or establishment. Alternatively, there lies a need for an improved and better quality roof, wall, floor panels, etc., as may be used for constructing the modular housing system.

(7) Further, there lies a need for mechanical or electromechanical connectors for all the prefabricated components for simplifying and standardizing a connection across all the panels, allowing adjustment and/or replacement of the panels upon or after installation, and yet nonetheless providing a robust, dependable, water-tight interconnection. Such interconnection needs to be as robust as a permanent connection of a non-modular building system made of non-prefabricated components to not compromise quality.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) Embodiments for constructing and interconnecting building blocks/modules in construction technology are disclosed that address at least some of the above challenges and issues.

(9) In a first aspect, the present subject matter is directed to a modular building system, comprising a wall panel and a floor panel. The wall panel comprises a plurality of sheets disposed adjacently, a horizontal member supported along a bottom horizontal edge formed by adjacent disposition each of said sheets, and a plurality of vertical studs integral to the horizontal member and extending vertically downward from the horizontal member. The floor panel comprises a rail rigidly fixed to the ground or other foundation and defining an enclosure to receive the plurality of vertical studs of the wall panel and thereby vertically support the wall panel upon the foundation.

(10) In an alternative embodiment, the plurality of sheets of the wall panel comprises a gypsum board, a plurality of metal studs to support the gypsum board, a plurality of metal column studs placed between the metal studs, mineral wool disposed between the metal studs, a sheathing board comprising a first cement board, an insulation layer, and an external cladding layer comprising a second cement board.

(11) In an alternative embodiment, the modular building system further comprises a roof panel having a plurality of layers comprising one or more of a waterproofing membrane, a sheathing board, a plywood layer, a light gauge steel (LGS) based structure exhibiting a slope with respect to a surface of the waterproofing membrane, and a gypsum board ceiling. The roof panel further comprises a plurality of metal column studs interspersed in mineral wool above and below the LGS structure, wherein the mineral wool is held between the sheathing board above and below the LGS structure. An external

cladding layer and an insulation layer are further provided.

(12) In an alternative embodiment, each of the wall panel and the roof panel further comprises one or more connectors for achieving a connection with one or more of the wall panels and an other roof panel. The connector within the wall panel and the roof panel comprises at least one first vertical stud supported along a first vertical face, and at least one second vertical stud supported along a second vertical face opposite the first vertical face.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Further advantages of the invention will become apparent by reference to the detailed description of preferred embodiments when considered in conjunction with the drawings. In the drawings, identical numbers refer to the same or a similar element.

(2) FIGS. 1(a) and (b) illustrate a wall panel and a floor panel during different stages of installation in construction technology in accordance with an embodiment.

(3) FIGS. 2(a) and (b) illustrate, respectively, the wall panel of FIG. 1 as mounted upon the floor panel and a cross-sectional view of the wall panel in accordance with an embodiment.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates an exploded view of the wall panel of FIG. 2 detached from the floor panel in accordance with an embodiment.

(5) FIGS. 4 (a) and (b) illustrate an arrangement for lifting the wall panel in accordance with an embodiment.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates an elevation view depicting a wall panel to wall panel connection in accordance with an embodiment.

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates an elevation view depicting an integrated view of the wall panel to wall panel connection of FIG. 5 in accordance with an embodiment.

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example roof panel in accordance with an embodiment.

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a sectional view of the roof panel of FIG. 7 in accordance with an embodiment.

(10) FIG. 9 illustrates an example step of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment.

(11) FIGS. 10(a), (b) and (c) illustrate other example steps of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment.

(12) FIG. 11 illustrates yet another example step of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment.

(13) FIG. 12 illustrates yet another example step of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment.

(14) FIG. 13 illustrates method steps of installation of panels in accordance with an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(15) The following detailed description is presented to enable any person skilled in the art to make and use the invention. For purposes of explanation, specific details are set forth to provide a thorough understanding of the present invention. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that these specific details are not required to practice the invention. Descriptions of specific applications are provided only as representative examples. Various modifications to the preferred embodiments will be readily apparent to one skilled in the art, and the general principles defined herein may be applied to other embodiments and applications without departing from the scope of the invention. The present invention is not intended to be limited to the embodiments shown, but is to be accorded the widest possible scope consistent with the principles and features disclosed herein.

(16) With modernization in construction-related technologies, there has been a rapid shift from normal customized build on-site construction methodologies to construction using modules or blocks that can be built off-site. However, in such an approach, it may be of utmost concern that the modules are manufactured in such a manner that they are easy to transport, integrate, assemble, or mount on any construction site. Current manufacturing technologies fail to address this concern. The embodiments of the present disclosure address this concern by providing improved, multi-layered and robust prefabricated components.

(17) Yet another important consideration may be that the boundary conditions of each module are sealed from the outside as well as inside continuously. In other words, the modules need to be structurally, mechanically, and aesthetically well connected/integrated with each other. Such seamless integration of modules on the construction site remains an unresolved challenge. The embodiments of the present disclosure address this challenge at least by providing improved and robust interconnecting arrangements among the prefabricated components.

(18) While wooden studs were traditionally used to withstand a load of walls (interior and exterior) and roofs, steel studs have been employed and preferred over wooden studs in the construction business due to their various advantages. For example, steel studs are fire-resistant, rigid, lightweight, stable, and dimensionally controllable, and exhibit more resistance to earthquakes and tornadoes. In addition, when compared with wooden studs, steel studs remain unaffected by problems like rotting, cracking, shrinking, and termite-attack.

(19) Construction technology in this disclosure proposes the use of fully loaded 2D Light Gauge Steel (LGS) panels for roof and walls coupled with other building blocks. The current disclosure also provides various embodiments of bathroom pods, modular kitchen, precast foundation(s), and floors, to construct high quality, highly sustainable homes/buildings while addressing the above noted concerns and challenges. The disclosed solution/architecture provides an improved multi-layered assembly of prefabricated components such as roof panels, floor panels, and wall panels to withstand load, climate changes, and daily wear and tear as may be subjected to any house or establishment. Further, the disclosed solution/architecture provides mechanical or electromechanical connectors (e.g. female-male pair based or otherwise “matched” connectors) for all the prefabricated components for simplifying and standardizing a connection across all the panels, which in turn allows adjustment and/or replacement of the panels upon installation, and last but not the least provides a robust, dependable, water-tight interconnection amongst the panels.

(20) Certain terms and phrases have been used throughout the disclosure and will have the following meanings in the context of the ongoing disclosure.

(21) “LGS” refers to Light Gauge Steel framing, which is a construction technology that uses cold-formed steel as a construction material.

(22) “MEP” refers to Mechanical, Electrical, and Plumbing technical disciplines for making any building site suitable for human occupancy.

(23) “HVAC” refers to Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning systems for providing heating and cooling to any building site.

(24) “R-value” refers to a measure of thermal resistance, where R stands for resistance to heat flow. An R-value is specified for every layer of material, and United States energy codes only refer to the R-values of insulation layers in the prescriptive R-value compliance path.

(25) “IECC” refers to the International Energy Conservation Code. IECC provides three paths for compliance for a building envelope. The first path specifies the required minimum level of insulation in the wall, i.e., R-value; the second path specifies U-factors for the building envelope components; and the third path, in which an annual energy use analysis is required, is based on the total building energy cost budget for heating, cooling, and service water heating.

(26) “SFH” refers to single-family home, which typically has one unit intended to house a single family.

(27) “Wall panel” refers to a prefabricated multi-layered wall fabricated at an offsite location and installed on-site, wherein “on-site” denotes a construction site and “offsite” denotes away from the construction site.

(28) “Floor panel” refers to a prefabricated multi-layered floor fabricated at an offsite location and installed on-site.

(29) “Roof panel” refers to a prefabricated multi-layered truss based roof fabricated at an offsite location and installed on-site.

(30) “Horizontal track” refers to a rail component to vertically support components upon a foundation, ground or other origin.

(31) “Vertical studs” refers to metallic columns or protrusions extending from a structure and capable of being fastened to another structure to connect both structures.

(32) “Swaged studs” refers to male metallic connectors for mechanical linkage.

(33) “Unlipped studs” refers to female metallic connectors for acting as a receptacle to the “Swaged studs”.

(34) “Modular” refers to any mechanism involving arrangement of individual and independent blocks.

(35) In accordance with the embodiments of the invention a modular building system comprises a wall panel, a floor panel, and a roof panel. The wall panel comprises a horizontal member supported along a bottom horizontal edge of the wall panel and a plurality of vertical studs integral to the horizontal member and extending vertically downward from the horizontal member. A floor panel comprises a rail disposed rigidly fixed to the ground and defining an enclosure to receive the plurality of vertical studs of the wall panel to vertically position the wall panel upon the ground.

(36) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the rail is a horizontal track riveted to the ground and accommodates the vertical studs of the wall panel.

(37) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the vertical studs of the wall panel are screw-fastened to the horizontal track.

(38) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the wall panel further comprises one or more connectors for achieving a connection with an other wall panel, said one or more connectors comprising at least one of: a first vertical stud supported along a first vertical edge of the wall panel, and a second vertical stud supported along a second vertical edge opposite the first vertical edge of the other wall panel.

(39) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the first vertical stud and the second vertical stud comprise a pair of male and female connectors to connect the wall panel with the other wall panel, and wherein the first vertical stud of the wall panel connects with the second vertical stud of the another wall panel through a screw fastener.

(40) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the wall panel further comprises a plurality of sheets disposed adjacently, wherein the plurality of sheets of the wall panel comprise one or more of: a gypsum board, a mineral wool disposed between metal studs, a sheathing board comprising a first cement board, an insulation layer, and an external cladding layer comprising a second cement board.

(41) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, a roof panel has a plurality of layers comprising one or more of a water proofing membrane, a sheathing board, a plywood layer, and a false ceiling.

(42) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the roof panel further comprises a light gauge steel (LGS) based structure having an elevation angle relative to a surface of the water proofing membrane, a plurality of metal column studs interspersed in mineral wool above and below the LGS structure, an arrangement to connect with the wall panel, and a cantilever arrangement.

(43) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the roof panel further comprises one or more connectors for achieving a connection with one or more of the wall panel and another roof panel, said connectors comprising at least one first vertical stud supported along a first vertical face, and at least one second vertical stud supported along a second vertical face opposite the first vertical face.

(44) In accordance with the embodiments of this disclosure, the at least one first vertical stud and the at least one second vertical stud comprise a pair of male and female connectors to connect the roof panel with an other roof panel, and wherein the at least one of the roof panel connects with the at least one second vertical stud of the other roof panel through a screw fastener.

(45) FIG. 1 illustrates a wall panel and a floor panel in construction technology in accordance with an embodiment. As such, FIG. 1 illustrates building blocks comprising a wall panel **102** and a floor panel **104** in construction technology in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The building blocks include the wall panel **102**, the floor panel **104**, and a roof panel (shown below in FIG. 7). In this embodiment, although three building blocks are illustrated, it will be apparent to a person with ordinary skill in the art that a building may also be constructed using any number of building blocks on a precast modular foundation. In an embodiment, each of the aforesaid building blocks may include sub-modules or sub-blocks that can be independently manufactured and assembled in a factory setting. In an embodiment, the building blocks may be assembled as part of a modular home, where the modular blocks are built entirely in a factory setting and subsequently assembled or mounted on the construction

site. In another embodiment, one or more building blocks may be built in the factory while other building blocks of the building may be built on-site. In an embodiment, any combination of building blocks may be built on-site and off-site to construct a home/building. For each building block illustrated in FIG. 1, placement details will be explained in detail in forthcoming figures.

(46) The floor panel **104** comprises a rail or a horizontal track, i.e. a swaged/unlipped stud that provides an enclosure and thereby acts as a receptacle for the studs of the wall panel **102**. The horizontal track is rigidly fixed (e.g., riveted) to the ground and defines an enclosure to receive a plurality of vertical studs (shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3 below) of the wall panel **102** and thereby vertically support the wall panel **102** upon the ground. As shown in FIG. 1a, the wall panel **102** may be lifted and dropped upon the horizontal track of the floor panel **104**. The horizontal track of the floor panel **104** acts as the receptacle for the plurality of vertical studs which are provided at the bottom of the wall panel **102**. As further shown in FIG. 1b, the wall panel **102** is placed upon the floor panel **104**. In such a scenario, the vertical studs of the wall panel **102**, once received within the floor panel **104**, are fastened to the walls of the horizontal track of the floor panel **104** on both interior and exterior sides, such as by screw fastening. As may be understood, the screw fastening affords replaceability, versatility, time efficiency of fastening and robustness. Here the fastening may be also construed to cover other analogous mechanisms, such as welding or self-tapping screw fastening, which requires no pilot holes or prelocation. In an example, the receiving of the vertical studs within floor panel **104** may comprise coupling with a male-female mechanical connection such that vertical studs may comprise a male connector and the floor panel **104** may comprise a female connector.

(47) FIGS. 2(a) and (b) illustrate, respectively, the wall panel **102** as mounted upon the floor panel **104** and a cross-sectional view of the wall panel **102** in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 2 will be explained in conjunction with the description of FIG. 1. In particular, FIG. 2 illustrates the wall panel **102** as mounted upon the floor panel **104** and a cross-sectional view of the wall panel **102** in the mounted state.

(48) FIG. 2a shows an exploded view depicting the wall panel **102** above, and thereby detached from, the floor panel **104**. One face of the wall panel **102** may be provided with a pair of adjacently placed termination flashings **202-1** and **202-2** at the bottom of the wall panel **102**. As may be understood, termination flashing may be a multi-purpose, preformed, professional way to attach a wide variety of construction waterproofing, drainage boards, and panel systems. The termination flashing **202-1** may be powder-coated aluminum termination flashing which, as one example, may be Tamlyn or equivalent without departing from the scope of the ongoing description. The termination flashing **202-2** may be powder-coated aluminum L flashing or equivalent without departing from the scope of the ongoing description.

(49) As one example, the horizontal track of the floor panel **104** is riveted or otherwise fastened to a foundation or the ground **204**, for example, through a pneumatic pin fastener **206**. As may be understood, the pneumatic pin fastener **206** is a rivet type connector that is driven by tools powered by air delivered from an air compressor. The foundation **204** may be formed of reinforced cement concrete (RCC) or any equivalent without departing from the scope of the ongoing description. In another example, the horizontal track **104** may also be installed within the foundation **204** by using, for example, a cement concrete mixture instead of the pneumatic pin fastener **206**.

(50) In another example, instead of RCC, the foundation or ground **204** may itself be a prefabricated panel comprising an R-15 Rigid Polyurethane Foam Insulation layer that may be placed contiguously followed, sequentially, by a Moisture Barrier layer, a Granular fill layer, and a Subgrade. In an embodiment, the thickness of the R-15 Rigid Polyurethane Foam Insulation layer may be 3 inches. In an embodiment, alternatively batt insulation may be used instead of R-15 Rigid Polyurethane Foam Insulation layer. The quick join-and-attach features of the wall panel **102** facilitate rapid placement, assembly, and dimensional predictability amongst other things.

(51) FIG. 2b shows the wall panel **102** and the floor panel **104** connected to each other and a subsequent floor finishing and skirting, as may be performed post connection, to achieve a seamless connection. More specifically, following the wall panel **102** placement over the floor panel **104**, finished flooring and base trim may be performed. A result of such finishing has been denoted by reference number **208**.

Additionally, a zip system sheathing **210** may be provided as insulation post fastening of the wall panel **102** with the floor panel **104**. In an example, the insulation as provided by zip system sheathing **210** may be thermal, electrical or a combination of both. It will be appreciated that, as in other figures described herein, the layers shown in FIG. **2(b)** may be coupled others, such as through intermediate layers (not shown).

(52) Zip-type sheathing provides several advantages. For example, the rigid foam isolation board is attached, providing the building-code-required thermal break between the sheathing and the steel stud. Additionally, the zip outside the sheathing provides for direct mechanical/structural attachment of any siding (e.g., cement board, rain screen, masonry, stucco, etc.).

(53) FIG. **3** illustrates an exploded view to depict the wall panel detached from the floor panel in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. **3** will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**.

(54) FIG. **3** illustrates an exploded view of the structure of FIG. **2**, depicting the wall panel **102** above, and thereby detached from, the floor panel **104**. Specifically, FIG. **3** illustrates an enlarged cross-sectional view of the wall panel **102** to depict a structural composition of the wall panel **102** in accordance with an embodiment. The wall panel **102**, for example, may be a standard 4-foot grid-sized LGS wall panel, which is fully assembled in-factory using LGS for studs, structural framework with insulation, windows (exterior), doors (interior and exterior), and sheathing. As one example, the wall panel **102** may be 8 feet wide and 11 to 14 feet high. However, the dimensions of wall panel **102** are for illustration purposes only and may change in accordance with the requirements and/or design specifications, amongst any other factors within the scope of the present disclosure. In an embodiment, the interior of the wall panel **102** may optionally include unplasticised polyvinyl chloride (UPVC) windows and the surrounding/remaining portion of the wall panel **102** may be layered by interior finishes.

(55) There are notable advantages of the depicted wall panel **102** such as its quick-join features which allow for the rapid assembly of extendable walls, and enable dimensional predictability as further depicted in FIG. **5** and FIG. **6**. Further, lifting features and packing of the wall panel **102** allow for fast and accurate logistics and assembly on-site as further depicted in FIG. **4**. Overall, a modular design of the wall panel **102** as depicted in FIG. **3** allows for flexible configuration, manufacturing, and assembly processes. Additionally, the combined joining techniques allow for a very high level of finish (in some cases, as high as 85%) of components directly out of factory.

(56) As depicted in the cross-sectional view of the wall panel in FIG. **3**, the wall panel **102** comprises a plurality of sheets or layers **301-306** disposed adjacently. On the interior side of the wall panel **102**, a gypsum board **301** is placed. In an embodiment, the gypsum board **301** may have a thickness of about 1-1.5 inches. A gypsum board may be understood as a drywall used as a building material for wall, ceiling, and partition systems in building structures.

(57) The gypsum board **301** of the wall panel **102** may be supported by cold formed steel (CFS) based frames. Metal studs as a part of frame of the wall panel **102** may extend from the CFS frames. In one embodiment, the metal studs are 3.5-inch wide studs. However, such dimensions of metal studs are for illustration purposes only and may vary based on internal and external factors or other specifications. Further, mineral wool or R-13 Batt insulation **302** may be placed between the metal studs, for example, in the form of a close cell spray configuration for thermal and electrical shock prevention due to the presence of metal studs. As may be understood, in some embodiments the metal studs may be needed for a rigid frame of the wall panel **102** but remain prone to electrical shock and thermal heating. The R-13 Batt insulation provides insulation for the metal studs. In one embodiment, the zip sheathing has 1 inch foam board attached directly to the steel studs (on the outside portion of the wall and/or roof trusses) to provide an electrical and thermal break. Typically, the insulation between the studs on the inside surface of the walls, trusses, or both is to meet any required local building R performance/standards. In an embodiment, the mineral wool has a thickness of about 3.5 inches. However, the thickness of the mineral wool **302** may vary based on internal and external factors.

(58) After the mineral wool **302** (e.g., traversing from the innermost to the outermost layer), a rigid insulation layer **303** is placed, preferably to provide a thermal break between the steel studs and outside

finishes. In an embodiment, the rigid insulation layer **303** may have a thickness of about 1 inch and may vary based on internal and external factors. In another embodiment, the rigid insulation layer **303** may comprise a Zip system R-6 rigid foam insulation board.

(59) Subsequent to the layer of rigid insulation **303**, a sheathing board **304** is placed to provide both structural integrity and an outside surface to mount finish, roof materials, or both. In an embodiment, the sheathing board **304** is “Zip System 7/16 inches plywood (OSB) sheathing.” In another embodiment, the sheathing board **304** may be an Oriented strand board (OSB), MgO, cement board, etc. In another embodiment, the sheathing board **304** may have a thickness of about 0.5 inches. However, the dimensions of the sheathing board **304** are for illustration purposes only and may vary based on various factors.

(60) Next to the sheathing board **304**, an external cladding layer **305** is placed to provide the functionality of an external cement board as understood to a person skilled in art of building materials. In an embodiment, the external cladding layer **305** may be a cement board, about 5/16 inches thick. However, a person skilled in the art may select other available materials for external cladding layer **305** and accordingly select thickness based on design and purpose. The external cladding layer **305** provides an outside wall finish and, as some examples, can include brick, stucco, rainscreen, metal, porcelain tile, etc., or another material, similar to the zip outside layer, to provide an easy mechanical connection of outside finishes. The external cladding layer **305** may be joined with the sheathing board **304** using connector or joining means such as metal clamps **306** for cladding. The metal clamps **306** maybe “1 inches×2 inches” cement Board vertical members at 12 inches off center or 12 inches O.C. The number of metal clamps **306** to be used may depend on the number of wall panels. In an embodiment, the metal clamps **306** may be distributed evenly or unevenly between the cladding **305** and the sheathing board **304** to maintain continuity of the wall panel **102**.

(61) It will be appreciated that the sequence of layers is exemplary. In other embodiments, the layers may be interposed in different sequences, some layers may be omitted, and others added.

(62) Further, the wall panel **102** comprises a horizontal member **308** supported along a bottom horizontal edge formed by adjacent disposition of each of said sheets **301-306**. The horizontal member **308** may be a metal stud or CFS frame. Further, a plurality of vertical studs **310** are integrated with the horizontal member **308** and extend vertically downward from the horizontal member **308**.

(63) Further, as explained above, the floor panel **104** may comprise the horizontal track which is an unlippped/insulated track installed or fastened to the foundation **204**. As explained above, the horizontal track of the floor panel **104** receives the metal studs such as the vertical studs **310** to enable placement of the wall panel **102** upon the floor panel **104** thereby vertically supporting the wall panel **102** upon the ground. Thereafter, the vertical studs **310** are screw-fastened with the floor panel **104**. As may be understood, screw fastening affords replaceability, versatility, time efficiency of fastening, and robustness.

(64) FIGS. **4 (a)** and **(b)** illustrate an arrangement for lifting the wall panel **102** in accordance with an embodiment. FIGS. **4 (a)** and **(b)** will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. **1-3**.

(65) FIG. **4(a)** illustrates an arrangement for lifting the wall panel **102**, including lifting hooks or hangers **402** provided at a top track **404** of the wall panel **102**. Further, a number of service holes **406** are provided at the top track **404** within a pair of extended CFS frames **408** for receiving the lifting hooks **402**. Upon installation of the wall panel **102** upon the floor panel **104**, the extended CFS frames **408** may be removed from the wall panel **102**. In an example, vertical studs may also be provided at the top track **404** formed within the wall panel **102**. An example roof panel as later depicted in FIG. **7** may be provided with a horizontal track like the floor panel **104** to receive the vertical studs mounted at the top track **404** and thereby vertically connect the roof panel with the wall panel **102**.

(66) FIG. **4(b)** illustrates an example mechanism for holding and transferring the wall panel **102** using the arrangement for lifting the wall panel **102** as depicted in FIG. **4(a)**. In an example, the wall panel **102** may be hoisted, lifted, positioned through either a mechanical arrangement such as a pulley mechanism or electromechanically through a computer controlled crane **410** or an equivalent lifting mechanism, and a camera or other sensing means for aligning the walls and roof panels. Such lifting may be automated or semi-automated performed through a human operator and/or artificial intelligence.

(67) FIG. 5 illustrates an elevation view depicting a wall panel to wall panel connection in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 5 will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. 1-4.

(68) FIG. 5 illustrates an elevation view depicting a wall panel to wall panel mechanical connection between any two wall panels **102A** and **102B** (collectively, **102**) through cooperation between the vertical studs, i.e., an unlipped stud **502** of a first wall panel (**102A**) and a swaged stud **504** of a second wall panel (**102B**). The unlipped stud **502** acts as a receptacle and thereby receives the swaged stud **504** to connect the wall panels **102A** and **102B** adjacently. Both the unlipped stud **502** and the swaged stud **504** may be provided vertically along respective vertical edges (surfaces) of the wall panels **102A** and **102B** to thereby vertically connect the wall panels **102**. Further, the unlipped stud **502** and swaged stud **504** comprise a pair of male and female connectors to connect wall panel **102A** with the wall panel **102B**.

(69) With respect to the wall panel **102A**, the unlipped stud **502** may be supported along a first vertical edge as shown in FIG. 5. Accordingly, although not shown in the FIG. 5, the swaged stud **504** may also be supported within the same wall panel **102A** along a second vertical edge which is opposite or behind the first vertical edge. Further, for achieving the connection, the wall panel **102A** may be pushed against a stationary wall panel **102B** or vice-versa or both the panels **102A** and **102B** may be pushed against each other to enable insertion or securing of the swaged stud **504** within the unlipped stud **502**. In an example, the force required for such a pushing operation is provided through either a mechanical arrangement such as a pulley mechanism or electromechanically through a computer controlled robotic arm (as later shown in FIG. 10b). Such pushing operation may be automated or semi-automated, performed through a human operator and/or artificial intelligence.

(70) FIG. 6 illustrates an elevation view depicting an integrated view of the wall panel to wall panel connection in accordance with an embodiment.

(71) FIG. 6 illustrates an elevation view depicting an integrated view of the wall panel to wall panel connection. The connection may be a mechanical connection between the two wall panels **102** through a screw-fastener securely attaching the unlipped stud **502** of the wall panel **102A** with the swaged stud **504** of the wall panel **102B**. The unlipped stud **502** and the swaged stud **504** may be metallic or any other alloy based studs. In other words, the unlipped stud **502** of the wall panel **102A** receives the swaged stud **504** of the wall panel **102B** and both are secured together through a screw fastener **602**. As depicted in FIG. 6, the wall panels **102A** and **102B** are joined to form a continuous wall. In an example, at the junction between the two wall panels **102**, there may be an expansion gap covered or otherwise hidden by extra cladding material. The dimensions of wall panels **102** depicted in FIGS. 1 to 6 are for illustration purposes only and may vary from one construction site to another.

(72) FIG. 7 illustrates an example roof panel in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 7 will be explained in conjunction with the description of FIGS. 1-6.

(73) FIG. 7 illustrates an elevation view of a roof panel **700** in accordance with an embodiment. The roof panel **700** is built using LGS modular construction. Each exemplary roof panel **700** can be built as a module in-factory and completed with joists, plywood, insulation, and a false ceiling. As previously shown in FIG. 4, the roof panel **700** may be mounted on the top track **404** of wall panel **102** for quick attachment and assembly.

(74) The roof panel **700** includes a waterproofing membrane **702** that may for example be a Thermoplastic Polyolefin (TPO) single ply roofing laid over an ISO rigid insulation which is followed by a rigid insulation layer. In an embodiment, the thickness of the rigid insulation layer may be about 2 inches. However, the dimensions of the rigid insulation layer may vary based on internal and external factors. The rigid insulation layer is followed by a plywood layer **704**. The plywood layer **704** maybe a 5/8" OSB plywood decking. In some embodiments, the plywood layer **704** provides the same function as the outside wall finish described above.

(75) The plywood layer **704** is supported by a light gauge steel (LGS) roof joist **706** with about 1/2 degree slope or alternatively exhibiting an elevation angle of 45°. It may be noted that the degree of slope may vary based on the specifics and requirements of the construction site. In an embodiment, the LGS roof joist **706** may be followed by a false ceiling **712** that in turn may comprise a gypsum board **712**. In an embodiment, a batt type insulation **708** (e. g. R-38 Batt Insulation) may be used in the cavity of the roof

panel **700** for R38 roof performance.

(76) Metal column studs **710** above and below the LGS roof joist **706** may be covered by the batt type insulation's **708** mineral wool. In an embodiment, the metal column studs **710** may be about 3.5 inches by 3.5 inches and correspond to a CFS Truss 3.5 inches box design at 24 O.C. In an embodiment, the thickness of mineral wool covering the metal column studs **710** may be 3.5 inches. In an embodiment, the thickness of the plywood layer **704** on either side of the mineral wool is 0.5 inch.

(77) In an example, although not shown in FIG. 7, the plywood layer **704** may be followed by rigid insulation and external cladding layers. The external cladding layer and the rigid insulation layer are attached to each other using metal clamps for cladding. In an embodiment, the external cladding layer may be 0.5 inch thick cement board. Aluminum (AL) coping may be used to cover the structural components and/or layers up to the external cladding layer for weather sealing.

(78) Further, the roof panel **700** comprises a false ceiling, such as a gypsum board ceiling **712**, at the bottom, and an access panel **714** (for example of about 12 inches) adjacent to the gypsum board ceiling **712** to facilitate fastening of trusses of the roof panel **700** with the wall panel **102**. As may be understood, a truss is a structure that consists of members organised into connected triangles so that the overall assembly behaves as a single object. Upon such fastening, the access panel **714** may be finished with a cement board such as a gypsum board **720** to achieve a seamless connection. In addition, the roof panel **700** comprises at the edge a termination flashing **716** for waterproofing/sealing. A cantilever arrangement may be provided in the form of an overhang **718** that may be about 1 ft 4 inches long to render a balanced mounting of the roof panel **700** across the wall panel **102**.

(79) In accordance with an embodiment, the complete assembly from waterproofing membrane **702** at the top down to the gypsum board ceiling **712** at the bottom constitutes the roof panel **700**. Various units or modules of the roof panel **700** as depicted may be joined and replicated to form a complete roof at any construction site.

(80) FIG. 8 illustrates a sectional view of the example roof panel in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 8 will be explained in conjunction with description of FIGS. 1-7.

(81) FIG. 8 illustrates a sectional view of the roof panel **700** to depict electrical-equipment (s) provided as electrical fixtures and electrical components within the roof panel **700**. The electrical equipment as included within the roof panel **700** includes a raceway **802** for housing and routing electrical wires across the roof panel **700**. The electrical wires as routed are connected to an electrical box **804**, which in an example may be an electrical junction box (4×4) with or without a cover. A metal armored electrical cable **806**, which for example corresponds to a Wall Panel Whip, emerges from the electrical box **804** and is thereafter packed/concealed within the mineral wool of the roof panel **700**. The metal armored electrical cable **806** upon emerging outside the roof panel **700** is routed to an electrical load **808** or in another example a power source such as an electrical socket. In an example, as later shown in figures, the various roof panels **700** upon having been mechanically connected with each other may also be electrically connected either serially or in parallel as a daisy chain.

(82) It will be apparent to a person with ordinary skill in the art that dimensions and numbers utilized in the view of the roof panel **700** are for illustration purposes only, and such types of roof panels, number of units, and dimensions may vary based on construction site/purpose/budget/requirements, etc.

(83) FIG. 9 illustrates an example step of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. 9 will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. 1-8.

(84) FIG. 9 illustrates an example step of mechanically connecting roof panels **700A** and **700B** (collectively, **700**) with each other in accordance with an embodiment. Specifically, FIG. 9 represents an initial step of connecting the roof panels **700A** and **700B** such that panel **700B** may be lowered to be aligned to reach the same elevation as that of panel **700A**. In an example, the panel **700B** may be hoisted, lifted, positioned through either a mechanical arrangement such as a pulley mechanism or electromechanically through a computer controlled crane **906** or an equivalent hosting-lowering system. In an automated system, the crane **906** and computer are coupled to a camera or other sensor for sensing the location of the walls, roof panels, and track relative to each other. Such lifting/lowering may be automated or semi-automated, performed through a human operator and/or artificial intelligence. Further, the panel **700A** and panel **700B** are provided with an unlippped stud **902** and a swaged stud **904**

on respective vertical faces as proposed to contact each other to enable the mechanical connection between panel **700A** and panel **700 B**.

(85) With respect to the roof panel **700A**, the unlipped stud **902** may be supported along a first vertical edge of roof panel **700A**. Accordingly, although not shown in FIG. **9**, the swaged stud **904** may be supported within roof panel **700A** along a second vertical edge which is opposite the first vertical edge. (86) FIGS. **10(a)**, **10(b)** and **10(c)** (collectively, FIG. **10**) illustrate other example steps of mechanically connecting roof panels **700A** and **700B** in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. **10** will be explained in conjunction with the description of FIGS. **1-9**.

(87) FIG. **10** illustrates example steps of mechanically connecting roof panels **700A** and **700B** (collectively, **700**) with each other in accordance with an embodiment. As may be observed from FIG. **10a**, the panel **700B** is lowered and slid into proximity of panel **700A** to enable the mechanical contact between the unlipped stud **902** and the swaged stud **904**. As may be observed from FIG. **10b**, as a part of such lowering-sliding operation, the roof panel **700B** may be pushed against a stationary roof panel **700A** or both the panels **700A** and **700B** may be pushed against each other to enable insertion/securing of the swaged stud **904** within the unlipped stud **902**. In an example, the force required for such lowering-and-sliding operation is provided through either a mechanical arrangement such as a pulley mechanism or electromechanically through one or more computer controlled robotic arms **1002A** and **1002B** (collectively, **1002**). Such a pushing operation may be automated or semi-automated, performed through a human operator and/or artificial intelligence. Further, as may be observed from FIG. **10c**, the unlipped stud **902** acts as a receptacle to receive the swaged stud **904** and thereby define a male-female connector pair between panel **700A** and panel **700B**.

(88) FIG. **11** illustrates yet another example step of connecting the roof panels **700A** and **700B** in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. **11** will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. **1-10**.

(89) FIG. **11** illustrates yet another example step of mechanically connecting roof panels **700A** and **700B** with each other in accordance with an embodiment. More specifically, FIG. **11** depicts screw fastening the unlipped stud **902** and the swaged stud **904** upon reaching the contacting position or connection as depicted in FIG. **10b**. For effecting this screw fastening mechanism, a TPO membrane **1102** corresponding to the TPO membrane **702** as depicted in FIG. **7** may be lifted for either one or both the panels **700A** and **700B** to thereby expose the contacting unlipped stud **902** and the swaged stud **904** and provide an ease of incorporating a screw fastener therebetween. Thereafter, the contacting studs **902**, **904** as exposed are screw-fastened with each other. For example, for screw fastening, a through-bore may be created across the studs **902**, **904** through an example drill machine-based mechanism to achieve a drilled portal hole. Thereafter, a threaded bolt may be inserted through the through-bore and a threaded nut may be used to lock the threaded bolt and achieve the screw-fastening.

(90) FIG. **12** illustrates yet another example step of connecting roof panels in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. **12** will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. **1-11**.

(91) FIG. **12** illustrates yet another example step of mechanically connecting roof panels **700A** and **700B** with each other in accordance with an embodiment. Specifically, post achievement of screw fastening between the unlipped stud **902** and the swaged stud **904** depicted in FIG. **11**, the lifted TPO membranes **702** of either one or both panels **700A** and **700B** in FIG. **11** are now welded together to achieve seamless connectivity at the top of both panels A and B.

(92) FIG. **13** illustrates method steps of installation of panels in accordance with an embodiment. FIG. **13** will be explained in conjunction with the descriptions of FIGS. **1-12**.

(93) FIG. **13** illustrates the steps of a method **1300** of installing one or more prefabricated wall panels **102** on a building foundation, i.e., the floor panel **104**, followed by installation of the roof panels **700** upon the wall panels **102**. Although specific operations are disclosed in FIG. **13**, such operations are examples. In different embodiments, to name only a few examples, the method **1300** may include other operations, the sequence of the operations can be modified, some steps may be omitted, or any combination of these variations may be incorporated. The steps of method **1300** may be automated or semi-automated. In various embodiments, one or more of the operations of the method **1300** can be controlled or managed by software, by firmware, by hardware, or by any combination thereof, but is not

limited to such.

(94) Method **1300** can include processes of various embodiments of the present disclosure which can be controlled or managed by a processor(s) and electrical components under the control of a computer or computing device comprising computer-readable and executable instructions or code. The readable and executable instructions (or code) may reside, for example, in data storage such as volatile memory, non-volatile memory, and/or mass data storage, as only some examples. As explained later, automation of method **1300** through computer employs various peripherals such as sensors, robotic arms etc. to operate upon panels **102**, **104** and **700** during installation.

(95) To generalize the explanation that follows, it is presumed that the first prefabricated wall **102A** has already been erected, and the second prefabricated wall **102B** is to be erected so that the two are adjacent to each other. However, such generalized description is merely for sake of simplicity of explanation and present subject matter may also be construed to cover simultaneous installation of all panels **102**, **104** and **700** without any prior implementation.

(96) It will be appreciated that the steps to erect wall panels **102A** are similar to those for wall panel **102B**, except that no adjacent wall has yet been installed. In this example, in an initial step, the “next” wall panel is the first wall panel **102A**. In this initial step, no “adjacent” wall panel has yet been installed. In the second iteration, described below, the “next” wall panel is the second wall panel **102B**, and the “adjacent” wall panel is the wall panel **102A**.

(97) At step **1302**, a second (“next”) wall panel **102B** is obtained. The second wall panel **102B** may be hooked on a top track **410** along a top horizontal edge of the second wall panel **102B** in accordance with the description of FIG. 4.

(98) At step **1304**, the second wall panel **102B** is positioned to align with the rail **104** and any other adjacent wall panel (here, the first wall panel **102A**). More specifically, in step **1302**, the hooked wall panel **102B** is lowered onto the rail **104** and thereafter released from the hook. For such purposes, the second prefabricated wall panel **102B** having a bottom horizontal surface with a second bottom connector **310B** (here, the label “B” denoting a component of the second wall panel **102B**) is lowered onto the rail **104** coupled to a foundation **204** of a building, the rail **104** having a top horizontal surface with a top connector. The second bottom connector **310B** comprises studs and the top connector of the rail **104** comprises recesses or enclosures configured to receive the studs **310B**. The second wall panel **102B** further comprises a second side surface with a wall connector **502B** configured to couple the second wall panel **102B** to the first wall panel **102A**, the first wall panel **102A** comprising a first side surface with a first wall connector matched to the second wall connector. The first wall connector comprises an unlipped stud **502A**, and the second wall connector comprises a swaged stud **504B**. The second wall panel **102B** may also be lowered towards the rail **104**, the second wall panel having a second bottom horizontal surface comprising a second bottom connector **310B**, until at least a portion of the second bottom connector **310B** is inserted into the rail **104**. The second wall panel **102B** may be moved or pushed so that the second side connector or the swaged stud **504B** aligns with the first side connector or the unlipped stud **502A**.

(99) At step **1306**, the second wall panel **102B** is fixedly coupled to the rail **104** and the adjacent wall panel, the first wall panel **102A**. The second bottom connector **310B** is coupled to the top connector of the rail **104** to secure the second prefabricated wall panel **102B** to the rail **104**, thereby vertically affixing the second wall panel **102B** to the foundation **204**. More specifically, the second bottom connector **310B** is screw-fastened to the rail **104**. Further, the first side connector **502A** and the second side connector **504B** are also fastened together through screw fastening to achieve coupling there-between.

(100) At step **1308**, a roof panel **700B** is retrieved.

(101) At step **1310**, the roof panel **700B** is positioned to align with the wall panels **102A**, **102B** and any adjacent roof panel, here, first roof panel **700A**. More specifically, the roof panel **700B** is secured over top horizontal edges **410B** of the second wall panel **102B** and the first wall panel **102A** through a truss. Further, the roof panel **700B** maybe sidewise secured to the other (e.g., adjacent) roof panel **700A** in accordance with the description of FIG. 9 and FIG. 10.

(102) At step **1312**, the roof panel **700B** is fixedly coupled with the wall panels **102A**, **102B** and the adjacent roof panel **700A** through screw fastening or welding, to name only a few examples, as

explained in the descriptions of FIG. 9 to FIG. 12.

(103) At step **1314**, it is checked if there are any further panels pending for installation from amongst the panels **102** and **700**. If yes, then a control is transferred back to the step **1302** to undergo further iterations of the method **1300**. Otherwise, the method **1300** terminates.

(104) In one aspect, a system for performing the steps **1300** is automated. As one example, referring to FIG. 9, the system comprises (1) a camera arrangement, optical sensor, or other sensor arrangement (e.g., light source **950** and sensor **955**) for sensing the relative locations of the components, including the wall panels **102A** and **102B**, rail **104**, and roof panels **700A** and **700B**, (2) a crane **906** for hoisting, lowering, and adjusting the components relative to each other, (3) an arm (e.g., crane arm **912** or robotic arms **1002A** and **1002B**, FIG. 10(b)) for securing the components to each other, and (3) a computer operatively coupled to the crane **906**, the crane arm **912**, and the robotic arms **1002A** and **1002B**, the computer receiving the relative locations and, using the relative locations, the crane, and the arm (crane arm, robotic arm, or both) performing the steps **1300**. Preferably, the computer comprises a memory storing computer-executable instructions that when executed perform the steps **1300**. In different embodiments, a single robot arm or a pair of robot arms can be used to hoist/lower components, align them, and secure them in place. In some embodiments, any combination of cranes, crane arms, and robot arms may be referred to as a “robot assembly.” In one embodiment, the sensor arrangement comprises a light source **950** positioned at the rightmost portion of FIG. 9 and a sensor **955** positioned at the leftmost portion, aligned such as to determine that the wall panels **102A** and **102B**, roof panels **700A** and **700B** are aligned. In one embodiment, the light pattern/intensity from the light source **950** impinging on the sensor **955** indicates a degree of alignment between the front surfaces of the panels **120A** and **120B**.

(105) While FIG. 9 shows a light source **950** and sensor **955** positioned on the right and left portions of FIG. 9 (e.g., on opposite vertical sides of the wall panels so that light is directed at the vertical faces of the wall panels), it will be appreciated that light source-sensor pairs can also be positioned at other locations to determine whether wall panels and roof panels are aligned with each other and the rail. Alternatively, or in addition, a camera capable of determining the depth of objects from the camera and from each other can be positioned to face the front faces, back faces, or both, of the panels to also align components. After reading this disclosure, those skilled in the art will recognize other structures for determining the position and alignment of the wall panels, roof panels, and rails.

(106) In an example, the wall panel **102**, the floor panel **104** and the roof panel **700** may be connected together as explained in the preceding figures to achieve a rapid construct cross-section in accordance with an embodiment. The rapid construct cross-section may be an LGS modular construction. A plurality of blocks, such as the rapid construct cross-section may be combined to allow rapid on-site assembly and completion of the house. In an embodiment, the rapid construct cross-section may be used for SFH.

(107) The rapid construct cross-section includes a bottom portion similar to the floor panel **104** discussed previously in FIGS. 1 to 3. The bottom portion of the rapid construct cross-section is attached to the foundation **204**. A middle portion of the rapid construct cross section is similar to the wall panel **102** discussed previously in FIG. 1 to FIG. 6. The top portion of the rapid construct cross section is similar to the roof panel **700** and roof panel details illustrated and discussed previously in FIG. 7 to FIG. 12. Therefore, a person with ordinary skill in the art will ascertain that, in accordance with one embodiment, the rapid construct cross section comprises a combination of building blocks such as the floor panel **104**, the wall panel **102**, and the roof panel **700**.

(108) The rapid construct blocks as may be obtained due to their construction technology, are high quality, forming repeatable and scalable SFH products. They form an IECC energy compliant high-performance envelope.

(109) With reference to the building blocks disclosed in FIGS. 1-13, it is to be noted that various joining methodologies and/or technologies may be utilized to join sub-modules/sub-units of individual building blocks or to join one building block with another. For example, joining technologies may be used to build modular building blocks that when assembled make a building envelope/enclosure structurally and environmentally seamless. In another example, interconnection methodologies may be used between foundation and wall; wall and wall; wall and roof truss; and roof truss and roof truss. In yet another example, interconnection methodologies may be used that speed up assembly processes and reduce the

need for skilled labor. In yet another example, interconnection technologies may be used that allow a high degree of module completion in the factory. In yet another example, digitization of modular building blocks may enable repeatability with higher quality levels than traditional methodologies. (110) The terms “comprising,” “including,” and “having,” as used in the specification herein, shall be considered as indicating an open group that may include other elements not specified. The terms “a,” “an,” and the singular forms of words shall be taken to include the plural form of the same words, such that the terms mean that one or more of something is provided. The term “one” or “single” may be used to indicate that one and only one of something is intended. Similarly, other specific integer values, such as “two,” may be used when a specific number of things is intended. The terms “preferably,” “preferred,” “prefer,” “optionally,” “may,” and similar terms are used to indicate that an item, condition, or step being referred to is an optional (not required) feature of the invention. The term “connecting” includes connecting, either directly or indirectly, and “coupling,” including through intermediate elements.

(111) The invention has been described with reference to various specific and preferred embodiments and techniques. However, it should be understood that many variations and modifications may be made while remaining within the spirit and scope of the invention. It will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that methods, devices, device elements, materials, procedures, and techniques other than those specifically described herein can be applied to the practice of the invention as broadly disclosed herein without resort to undue experimentation. All art-known functional equivalents of methods, devices, device elements, materials, procedures, and techniques described herein are intended to be encompassed by this invention. Whenever a range is disclosed, all subranges and individual values are intended to be encompassed. This invention is not to be limited by the embodiments disclosed, including any shown in the drawings or exemplified in the specification, which are given by way of example and not of limitation. Additionally, it should be understood that the various embodiments of the building blocks described herein contain optional features that can be individually or together applied to any other embodiment shown or contemplated here to be mixed and matched with the features of that building block.

(112) While the invention has been described with respect to a limited number of embodiments, those skilled in the art, having benefit of this disclosure, will appreciate that other embodiments can be devised which do not depart from the spirit and scope of the invention as disclosed herein.

Claims

1. A prefabricated roof panel comprising: a plurality of layers comprising one or more of: a water proofing membrane, a sheathing board, a plywood layer, and a false ceiling; a light gauge steel (LGS) structure exhibiting a slope relative to a foundation; a plurality of metal column studs interspersed in mineral wool above and below the LGS structure; an access panel adapted to facilitate a coupling of the prefabricated roof panel with a wall panel; one or more connectors for coupling the prefabricated roof panel to an other roof panel, wherein the one or more connectors comprising: at least a first vertical stud supported along a first vertical face of the prefabricated roof panel, wherein a male connector of the first vertical stud is configured to couple to a female connector of a second vertical stud of the other roof panel, wherein the second vertical stud supported along a second vertical face opposite to the first vertical face; and a cantilever arrangement.
2. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 1, further comprises a termination flashing for edge waterproofing.
3. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 1, wherein the cantilever arrangement is provided as an overhang to render a balanced mounting of the prefabricated roof panel across the wall panel.
4. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 1, further comprises a raceaway for housing and routing electrical wires across the prefabricated roof panel.
5. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 1, further comprises a first unlippped stud supported along a first vertical edge and a first swaged stud supported along a second vertical edge of the prefabricated roof panel, wherein the first vertical edge is opposite to the second vertical edge, wherein the first unlippped

stud of the prefabricated roof panel is adapted to mechanically connect to a second swaged stud of a first adjacent prefabricated roof panel, and wherein the first swaged stud of the prefabricated roof panel is adapted to mechanically connect to a second unlipped stud of a second adjacent prefabricated roof panel.

6. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 5, wherein the first unlipped stud and the first swaged stud of the prefabricated roof panel is mechanically connected to the second swaged stud of the first adjacent prefabricated roof panel and the second unlipped stud of the second adjacent prefabricated roof panel, respectively, via a fastening mechanism.

7. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 5, wherein the first adjacent prefabricated roof panel, the second adjacent prefabricated roof panel, and the prefabricated roof panel mechanically connected with each other are further electrically connected with each other, and wherein the electrical connection corresponds to a serial or a parallel connection.

8. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 5, wherein the mechanical connection of the first adjacent prefabricated roof panel, the second adjacent prefabricated roof panel, and the prefabricated roof panel is achieved using a pulley mechanism.

9. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 5, wherein the mechanical connection of the first adjacent prefabricated roof panel, the second adjacent prefabricated roof panel, and the prefabricated roof panel is achieved electromechanically using a computer-controlled crane communicatively coupled with one or more sensors.

10. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 5, wherein the mechanical connection of the first adjacent prefabricated roof panel, the second adjacent prefabricated roof panel, and the prefabricated roof panel is achieved electromechanically using an automated or semi-automated hosting-lowering system.

11. The prefabricated roof panel of claim 1, wherein the false ceiling at a bottom of the prefabricated roof panel and the access panel adjacent to the false ceiling are adapted to facilitate fastening of trusses of the prefabricated roof panel with the wall panel.
